



LATER GATOR

USER STORIES

PREPARED FOR

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Later Gator User Stories

As a user of Later Gator, I want to develop healthier screen time habits so I can stay focused on what really matters in my daily life. This means building awareness of my device use, reducing distractions, and creating a balance between productivity and relaxation. Later Gator should help me stay accountable to my goals while also being easy to use, so that forming new habits or changing old ones feels achievable rather than overwhelming. By combining clear tracking, supportive feedback, and flexible controls, the app should empower me to make lasting changes without adding unnecessary friction to my routine.

1. Setup & Settings

Onboarding

As a new user, I want an initial setup plan so I can establish baseline goals and personalize the app from the start.

Conversation:

- How should baseline usage be established?
- What should the first goals look like?

Acceptance Criteria:

- Guided onboarding flow with baseline measurement
- Initial plan generated with general recommendations
- User sets personal goals during onboarding

Customizable Modes

As a user, I want different modes (Focus, Vacation) so I can quickly adapt the app to different situations.

Conversation:

- What behaviors should each mode (Focus, Vacation) enable/disable?
- Should tracking always continue across all modes?
- How does the user switch between modes quickly?
- How are Vacation Mode and Emergency Bypass different in practice?

Acceptance Criteria:

- On/Off mode
- Focus (Study/Homework) mode:
 - Only allows specific apps or websites so I can focus on assignments without distractions (request to match device DND settings)

- Customizable list of allowed apps/websites
- Integration with Pomodoro timer (scenery integration - mood appropriate)
- Vacation mode
 - Stops limit notifications and blocks
 - Continues tracking and daily/weekly notificaitons

Customizable Snooze Limits

As a user, I want to set the number of times I can snooze before lockout so I can avoid endless postponing.

Conversation:

- Should snooze limits reset daily or weekly?
- Should limits apply globally across all apps, or per app?
- Should the app warn the user when their last snooze is about to be used?
- Should snooze usage be included in weekly reports as a separate stat?

Acceptance Criteria:

- User can adjust snooze count in settings
- Snooze count tracked in weekly reports

2. Security

Data Protection

As a user, I want assurance that my data is secure so I can trust the app with my information.

Conversation:

- How will data be stored?
- How can users be assured their data is not misused?

Acceptance Criteria:

- Secure login
- All data stored locally on device
- No third-party sharing
- Minimal external/social features

3. Tracking & Reports

Daily and Weekly Tracking

As a user, I want to see a daily and weekly breakdown of my screen time so that I can understand my habits and track my progress toward healthier device use.

Conversation:

- How frequent should tracking logs be compiled?
- What should be shown in tracking logs?
- How does the user get notifications?
- Should tracking reports show restriction settings?

Acceptance Criteria:

- Weekly summary reports available in the app
- Notification that a weekly report is available
- Current time restriction and snooze limits reported for each app
- Track only “in focus” usage (not background)

App Usage Breakdown

As a user, I want to see and analyze what apps dominate my screen time so that I know which ones to target for limits.

Conversation:

- How should app usage be displayed to the user?
- Should usage breakdown show by category (social, productivity, entertainment, etc.)?
- Should suggestions be auto-generated or user-approved before blocking apps?
- How detailed should app usage be (minutes, hours, daily totals)?
- Should breakdowns highlight changes over time (week-to-week trends)?

Acceptance Criteria:

- Ranking list of apps with highest screen time
- Visual graphs of usage data
- Visual display alongside weekly report
- Suggestions generated from usage ranking
- Suggestions appear in weekly reports

4. Notifications & Check-ins

Reflective Check-ins

As a user, I want random short check-ins (“How focused are you right now?”) so I can stay mindful of my habits.

Conversation:

- How often should check-ins appear (random daily, set times, adjustable)?
- Should responses be optional or required?
- Should check-in results affect weekly reports (e.g., focus score)?

- Should the app adapt check-in frequency based on user engagement?

Acceptance Criteria:

- Randomized notification prompts
- Responses logged into weekly reports

Morning/Evening Reflections

As a user, I want quick daily check-ins (e.g., top 3 things on my to-do list for today/tomorrow) so I stay intentional with my time.

Conversation:

- Should reflections be guided with set prompts or open text?
- Should morning reflections tie into daily goals, and evening ones into review?
- Should users be able to customize their reflection questions?
- Should missed reflections trigger a reminder?

Acceptance Criteria:

- User can opt-in to morning and/or evening check-ins
- Responses saved in daily log; summarized in weekly report

Sleep Hygiene Reminders

As a user, I want reminders to wind down and stop using my phone before bed so I can improve my sleep quality.

Conversation:

- How much before bedtime should reminders appear (30 min, 1 hour, user-set)?
- Should reminders escalate (gentle → firm nudges)?
- Should reminders be tied to device data (e.g., screen brightness, late-night usage)?
- Should sleep reminders pause notifications from other categories?

Acceptance Criteria:

- Customizable bedtime reminder
- Notifications encouraging offline activities

Notification Engagement Level

As a user, I want control over how many notifications I receive so I don't feel overwhelmed or distracted.

Conversation:

- Should users set a maximum number of notifications per day, per week, or both?
- Should engagement level apply differently to reminders, check-ins, and reports?
- Should the app suggest lowering notification level if engagement drops?
- Should there be a "quiet hours" setting in addition to notification limits?

Acceptance Criteria:

- User can adjust notification frequency in settings
- Weekly report includes link to adjust notification preferences

5. Bypass & Overrides

Emergency Bypass

As a user, I want to bypass a time limit in case of an emergency without feeling like I am "cheating" the system.

Conversation:

- How should emergency bypass be implemented?
- Should bypassed apps be logged?

Acceptance Criteria:

- Emergency list available in settings
- Option to toggle restrictions "On/Off" for emergencies
- Tracking continues even when bypass is used

Snooze

As a user, I want the option to snooze a redirect notification for a limited time so I don't feel overly restricted but remain accountable. I also want additional warnings when I disable screen time blocks so I am reminded of my goals and encouraged to reconsider.

Conversation:

- How many snoozes are allowed?
- How long should a snooze last?
- Should snoozes be tracked?

Acceptance Criteria:

- User can set snooze limits in settings
- Snoozes logged and reported in weekly reports
- Default snooze time configurable
- Popup reminders of goals before disabling
- Alternative suggestions for activities shown

6. Positive Reinforcement

Rewards & Motivation

As a user, I want rewards when I meet my goals so I feel motivated to continue improving my screen time habits.

Conversation:

- What forms of rewards are most effective?
- Should rewards include streaks, levels, or both?

Acceptance Criteria:

- Point system with streak tracking
- Positive affirmations in weekly stats
- Visual rewards (Mascot gifs, animations)
- Comparison against baseline usage
- User-defined personal goals tied into notifications

7. Blocking Periods

Scheduled Blocking

As a user, I want to schedule blocking periods so I can create routines and stay focused at specific times of day.

Conversation:

- How granular can schedules be (days, hours, minutes)?
- How much control should users have?

Acceptance Criteria:

- User can schedule blocking periods by day/time
- Choice of apps included in each block
- Notifications when blocking begins/ends

Calendar Integration

As a user, I want the app to sync with my school calendar or to-do list so it knows when I should be focusing on work.

Conversation:

- Should events be auto-imported or user-selected?
- What happens if two events overlap or conflict (e.g., class vs. personal event)?
- Should the app create blocking automatically, or just suggest it?
- Should users get a preview of their schedule with blocking periods highlighted?

Acceptance Criteria:

- Calendar sync pulls scheduled tasks/events
- Blocking periods automatically aligned to events

Overall Goal Statement

By addressing screen time from multiple angles, tracking, overrides, positive reinforcement, focused blocking, personalized notifications, and secure settings, Later Gator creates a system that is both supportive and practical. The user can stay accountable without feeling restricted, receive encouragement without being overloaded, and make consistent progress toward healthier digital habits. Ultimately, Later Gator is designed to lessen the burden of change by making habit-building intuitive, motivating, and sustainable, helping users reclaim their time for what matters most.

Story Map

Workflow

Pod:
User Orientation

Juvenile:
Advance Features

Adult:
User Engagement

Priorities

Setup & Settings

Onboarding

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Customizable Snooze Limits

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Customizable Modes

As a user, I want different modes (Focus, Vacation) so I can quickly adapt the app to different situations.

Security

Secure Login

As a user I distinct profile restricted to my device so that personal information is not shared with others.

Data Protection

As a user, I want assurance that my data is secure so I can trust the app with my information.

Tracking & Reports

Daily & Weekly Tracking

As a user, I want to see a daily and weekly breakdown of my screen time so that I can understand my habits and track my progress toward healthier device use.

App Usage Breakdown

As a user, I want to see and analyze what apps dominate my screen time so that I know which ones to target for limits.

Sleep Hygiene Analysis

As a user, I want reminders to wind down and stop using my phone before bed so I can improve my sleep quality.

Notifications & Check-ins

Notification Engagement Level

As a user, I want control over how many notifications I receive so I don't feel overwhelmed or distracted.

Reflective Check-ins

As a user, I want random short check-ins ("How focused are you right now?") so I can stay mindful of my habits.

Morning/Evening Reflections

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Sleep Hygiene Reminders

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Bypass & Overrides

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Emergency Bypass

As a user, I want to bypass a time limit in case of an emergency without feeling like I am "cheating" the system.

Positive Reinforcement

Rewards & Motivation

As a user, I want rewards when I meet my goals, so I feel motivated to continue improving my screen time habits.

Blocking Periods

Scheduled Blocking

As a user, I want to schedule blocking periods so I can create routines and stay focused at specific times of day.

Pomodoro Mode

As a user I want a screen that has a personal mascot to implement of proven study intervals so that I can focus better.

Calendar Integration

As a user, I want the app to sync with my school calendar or to-do list so it knows when I should be focusing on work.